

Epson Stylus C45

Bangs Your Buck And Looks Cool too!

Epson's offering to the value home user. It's a sturdy little performer, but not as suitable for photo printing as some of the others here. The fact that Epson made this one real easy on the eye makes the C45 something you can live with on your desktop for quite a while!

Looks And Features

The C45 has the smallest footprint amongst the entry-level inkjets, and was the second-smallest of all the printers we received. A tiny retractable output tray adds to the overall compact image. The in-feeder has a small detachable paper guide and is top mounted—another neat space-saving trick.

We liked the colour combination, as well as the translucent top. Build quality was decent—sturdy enough for daily home use.

The ink monitoring software wasn't accurate. A few printouts down and the ink indicator dropped to 50 per cent, and stayed there for the rest of the tests!

Performance

The C45 was the slowest in our combi-document and photo printout tests, with an A4 photo taking nearly 17 minutes to complete: you can

actually take a coffee break after hitting the Print button! Our combi PDF file took seven minutes and 15 seconds to print—almost 40 per cent longer than its bigger brother, the C67, which at four minutes and 20 seconds was a slow-coach. Monochrome printing was a bit more acceptable, but still sorely slower than what we expected.

Quality-wise, text documents suffered at draft settings. At high quality, the fading disappeared, but there was noticeable blotting around the edges of the text.

For the combi-document, the C45 displayed colour detail quite well. It did not fare well in the contrast test (yellow text on a black background). Black text quality was not good, with visibly spiked fonts and ink blotting.

The A4 photo quality was surprisingly good, with decent colour vibrance and contrast, and accurate reproduction of detail. The photo wasn't very high-quality, but for Rs 3,295, this printer is an ideal buy for those on a shoestring budget who just need to print a few decent-quality photos.



Canon Pixma IP 1200

- ☑ Good build quality
 - ☑ Good looks
 - ☑ Decent at printing photos, but there are better options out there
 - ☑ Good value for money
 - ☑ Text printing suffers as far as quality goes
- Price: Rs 3,295

Epson Stylus C67

Looks Great, Prints Great, Goes Slow!

A great-looking printer that delivers on the performance front as well. It's stylish, prints well, and occupies a modest amount of desk space.

Looks And Features

The C67 is bigger and even better looking than the C45. The front portion falls open to double up as the output tray. The unit employs "DuraBrite Inks," claimed by Epson to be smudge- and water-resistant, as well as fade-resistant for 120 years! These tests are, however, carried out on Epson select photo paper, and the same won't hold true for other photo and normal papers.

The Epson C67 doesn't have the one black and one tri-colour set of cartridges that the C45 has. Instead, it has four individual cartridges—a popular setup for photo printers. The ink monitoring software worked fine on the C67, which made us believe the issue with the C45 was a one-off glitch.

Performance

While printing black text in Draft mode, there was noticeable artefacting, similar to the blotting on the C45 at high settings, but thankfully, there was no fading in the text. At high quality, some of the blotting prevailed, though it wasn't as noticeable. Surprisingly, the C67 was slower than the smaller C45, taking 40 and 54 seconds

respectively at the draft and high quality settings.

The PDF combi-document gave mixed results, with jagged spikes reappearing at both medium and high quality modes. Some of the high-contrast text was also not clearly visible at medium settings, though at high settings this was ironed out. The embedded photo was reproduced well, with good detailing, especially at high quality. The level of detail in the fruit scene was good, though the C45 highlighted the fruit better. Speed-wise, the C67 was slower than the competition but faster than the C45.

The C67 produced good A4 photos with good contrast and highlights, but missed out on colour gradation: the cloth settee in the background has several folds in the cloth, which weren't picked up properly. Facial features had good detail. The C67 took five minutes for the photo printout—which is more than three times faster than its sibling, though it's still slower than what we expected.

Overall, the difference between the C67 and C45 is small. If you're looking for an affordable printer that offers high-quality photos at Rs 4399, the C67 is a good pick.



Epson Stylus C67

- ☑ Good photo printing
 - ☑ Good for printing casual colour printing
 - ☑ Great looks and build quality
 - ☑ Suffers a bit as far as monochrome printing goes, but is more suitable for the task than its smaller brother the C45
 - ☑ Printing speed is slow for a printer of this class
- Price: Rs 4,399